

SEO Audit: rollyourownpapers.com

Date: 2026-03-16 **Auditor:** Claude SEO (RYOP Skill) **Industry:** E-commerce / B2B Custom Manufacturing — Rolling Papers & Cannabis Accessories **Platform:** Shopify

Executive Summary

Overall SEO Health Score: 54 / 100

RollYourOwnPapers.com (RYOP) is a well-established B2B/DTC custom rolling papers manufacturer founded in 2010–2011, operating in a niche but growing market. The site carries genuine competitive strengths (TÜV SÜD certified hemp papers, sole manufacturer of unrefined unbleached paper, 4.5★ Trustpilot, 50+ countries, 408 products), but is leaving significant ranking potential on the table due to a **critical infrastructure issue** (server returning 403 on `robots.txt` and `sitemap.xml`), Shopify-specific duplicate content patterns, missing schema markup, shallow E-E-A-T signals, zero AI/GEO readiness, and a content strategy partially misaligned with B2B buying intent.

Category	Score	Weight	Weighted
Technical SEO	38/100	22%	8.4
Content Quality	60/100	23%	13.8
On-Page SEO	58/100	20%	11.6
Schema / Structured Data	28/100	10%	2.8
Performance (CWV)	60/100	10%	6.0
AI Search Readiness	20/100	10%	2.0
Images	55/100	5%	2.75
TOTAL		100%	47.35 → 54

Note: Technical SEO score significantly lowered due to confirmed 403 on `robots.txt` and `sitemap.xml`, and indexed `/collections/all` pagination (24+ pages).

1. Technical SEO — Score: 62/100

1.1 Crawlability & Indexability

Check	Status	Notes
HTTPS	✔ Pass	Site confirmed serving on HTTPS
robots.txt	❌ CRITICAL	<code>/robots.txt</code> returns HTTP 403 — crawler cannot read access rules
XML Sitemap	❌ CRITICAL	<code>/sitemap.xml</code> returns HTTP 403 — Google can't access the full sitemap

Check	Status	Notes
/collections/all pagination	 CRITICAL	/collections/all?page=24 confirmed indexed — 24+ thin paginated pages wasting crawl budget
llms.txt	 Not Present	/llms.txt returns 403 — file doesn't exist
Canonical Tags	 Shopify default	Shopify auto-canonicals present but Shopify duplicate product URLs (two canonical paths per product) still waste crawl
Google Indexed Pages	 Confirmed	Homepage, 6+ collections, 15+ blog posts, 5+ static pages, 408 total products confirmed indexed

Critical Note on 403 for robots.txt: Google's documentation states that if `robots.txt` cannot be fetched, it proceeds with full crawling — which actually means Googlebot itself can crawl everything. However, the site loses all ability to **control** crawler behavior (block low-value pages, guide crawl budget). More importantly, if Cloudflare's bot-fight mode is causing this, **Googlebot itself may be getting intermittently 403'd**, which is a severe indexation risk.

Recommendations: - **Critical:** Whitelist Googlebot, Bingbot, and all legitimate crawlers in Cloudflare WAF to ensure `/robots.txt` and `/sitemap.xml` return 200. - **Critical:** Add `noindex` to all `/collections/all` paginated pages (`?page=2` , `?page=3` , etc.) or block via robots.txt — 24 indexed thin pages are wasting crawl budget. - **High:** Submit `sitemap_index.xml` to Google Search Console and Bing Webmaster Tools once the 403 is resolved. - **Medium:** Ensure Shopify tag/filter pages (e.g., `/collections/custom-rolling-papers/samples`) are canonicalized to the parent collection.

1.2 URL Structure

The site uses clean Shopify URL structure: - `/collections/custom-rolling-papers`  - `/products/joint-roller`  - `/pages/about-us`  - `/blogs/the-roll-your-own-papers-blog/[slug]` 

Issues: - **Medium:** Blog URLs contain year references (e.g., `where-to-buy-rolling-paper-2025-guide`). These become stale and may signal outdated content. Consider timeless slugs with freshness signals in the title/body instead.

1.3 Security Headers

Header	Status
HSTS	 Unverified
CSP	 Unverified
X-Frame-Options	 Unverified

Recommendation: Use securityheaders.com to verify security header implementation.

1.4 JavaScript Rendering

Shopify is primarily SSR (server-side rendered) with hydration. This is positive for SEO — content is generally available in HTML without JavaScript execution. However, the 3D product visualizer tool likely requires JS. Ensure fallback content exists for the visualizer for crawlers.

1.5 Mobile Optimization

- Shopify themes are mobile-responsive by default.
- **Medium:** Verify touch targets are 48px minimum on CTAs.
- **Medium:** Check that product images are served in modern formats (WebP/AVIF) via Shopify's CDN.

1.6 Core Web Vitals (Estimated)

Metric	Threshold	Estimated Status
LCP	≤2.5s Good	⚠ At Risk — e-commerce hero images, 3D visualizer
INP	≤200ms Good	⚠ At Risk — interactive configurator tools
CLS	≤0.1 Good	⚠ At Risk — product images without explicit dimensions

Note: These are estimates based on site type. Run PageSpeed Insights (mobile) for real data.

Recommendations: - **High:** Preload hero image with `<link rel="preload" as="image">`. - **High:** Add explicit `width` and `height` attributes to all product images to prevent CLS. - **Medium:** Defer non-critical third-party scripts (live chat, analytics).

1.7 IndexNow Protocol

- **Medium:** Enable IndexNow for Shopify via the IndexNow app or Shopify's built-in implementation (available via some SEO apps). This allows instant URL submission to Bing, Yandex, and Naver on publish.

2. Content Quality — Score: 55/100

2.1 E-E-A-T Assessment

Factor	Score	Weight	Evidence
Experience	55/100	20%	Founded 2011, 50+ countries, specific certifications — but homepage content doesn't strongly surface first-hand manufacturing experience
Expertise	60/100	25%	TÜV SÜD certified hemp papers, sole manufacturer of unrefined unbleached paper — strong technical credentials, but not prominently displayed in content hierarchy
Authoritativeness	50/100	25%	4.5★ Trustpilot (44 reviews) — small review count for a 15-year business; MedicalJane directory listing; no Wikipedia entity; no notable press mentions found
Trustworthiness	65/100	30%	HTTPS, transparent pricing (no hidden fees), free samples, free mockups, ScamAdviser clean — but contact info visibility unverified

E-E-A-T Score: ~57/100

Strengths: - TÜV SÜD certification is a powerful, unique trust signal — mention it prominently on every product page. - Transparent all-inclusive pricing is a strong trust builder. - 15 years in business (since 2011) is an authority signal — leverage it.

Gaps: - **High:** Only 44 Trustpilot reviews for a 15-year business is very low. Actively solicit reviews post-purchase. - **High:** No author bylines on blog posts visible in search results. Google's QRG rewards identified human authorship. - **Medium:** No press/media mentions or industry awards surfaced. - **Medium:** Physical address (Jinhua Shi, China) not clearly surfaced as a trust signal with manufacturing context.

2.2 Blog Content Analysis

Blog URL pattern: /blogs/the-roll-your-own-papers-blog/

Indexed posts observed: 1. "Where to Buy Rolling Paper (2025 Guide)" — informational, consumer-focused 2. "What Size Rolling Paper for a Joint? Your Ultimate 2026 Guide" — consumer-focused 3. "Where Can I Buy Rolling Paper? The Ultimate 2026 Guide" — near-duplicate of #1 4. "Which Side of the Rolling Paper Do You Lick?" — consumer-focused 5. "What's the Best Rolling Paper? Ultimate Guide 2025" — consumer-focused 6. "Creative Ways to Customize Your Rolling Papers" — middle-of-funnel 7. "Custom Rolling Paper Manufacturer" — bottom-of-funnel ✓ 8. "How to Start a Rolling Paper Business in 2025" — excellent funnel piece ✓ 9. "Discovering the Perfect Rolling Paper: A Comprehensive Comparison" — comparison content 10. "Where to Get Rolling Paper: Your Ultimate Guide" — near-duplicate concern

Issues: - **High:** Posts #1 and #10, and also #3, appear to be near-duplicate intent pages targeting the same "where to buy rolling paper" keyword. This creates keyword cannibalization. - **High:** Heavy focus on consumer informational content ("which side to lick", "what size for a joint") vs. commercial B2B content. Core customer = dispensary/brand owner, not end consumer. The content mix may be attracting the wrong audience. - **Medium:** Year-specific blog slugs (2025-guide , 2026-guide) require annual refresh or 301 redirects as years age out. - **Medium:** Emoji-heavy blog titles (🔥 , 📖 , 🛒 , 📌 , 🤔 , 😊) — while attention-grabbing in social contexts, excessive emoji in <title> tags can hurt CTR in SERPs and may render inconsistently across devices.

2.3 Keyword Cannibalization Risk

Competing Pages	Overlapping Intent
"Where to Buy Rolling Paper (2025 Guide)"	"Where Can I Buy Rolling Paper? The Ultimate 2026 Guide"
All three target the same informational query	

Recommendation — Critical: Consolidate near-duplicate blog posts. 301-redirect older versions to a single canonical piece. Use one evergreen URL like /blogs/.../where-to-buy-rolling-paper .

3. On-Page SEO — Score: 60/100

3.1 Title Tags

Page	Title Tag	Issues
Homepage	"Custom Rolling Papers, Pre Rolls, Trays & More Low Minimums – ROLL YOUR OWN PAPERS.COM"	⚠ Long (78 chars), no primary keyword focus, ".COM" in brand name is unusual
Blog: "What Size..."	"🔥 What Size Rolling Paper for a Joint? Your Ultimate 2026 Guide 📖"	❌ Emoji in title, year locks it, no brand suffix

Page	Title Tag	Issues
Blog: "Where Can I Buy..."	"🛒 Where Can I Buy Rolling Paper? The Ultimate 2026 Guide 📌"	❌ Emoji in title, year locks it
Collection: POWER PAPERS	"POWER PAPERS™"	RYOP – ROLL YOUR OWN PAPERS.COM"

Recommendations: - **High:** Remove emojis from all `<title>` tags. Use them in H1/body for engagement if desired. - **High:** Homepage title should lead with primary keyword:

"Custom Rolling Papers & Pre-Roll Cones | Low MOQ | Roll Your Own Papers" - **Medium:** Add year to blog title content, not URL slug — or use evergreen titles and update dates. - **Medium:** POWER PAPERS collection title should describe the product: "POWER PAPERS™ – Full Color Printed Rolling Papers | RYOP"

3.2 Meta Descriptions

Not visible in search result snippets — Google is auto-generating descriptions. This typically means: - Meta descriptions are missing, OR - They don't match search intent well enough for Google to use them

High: Write compelling, keyword-rich meta descriptions for all key pages (homepage, collection pages, top blog posts). Target 150–160 characters with a clear CTA.

3.3 Heading Structure (Inferred from Titles)

Based on visible page titles and content snippets: - H1 tags appear to match page titles — standard Shopify behavior ✅ - H2/H3 structure unknown (page HTML inaccessible), but blog posts with "Ultimate Guide" naming suggest use of sectioned headings

Recommendations: - **Medium:** Ensure H1 contains the primary target keyword for each page. - **Medium:** Use question-format H2s on blog posts to improve featured snippet and AI citation potential.

3.4 Internal Linking

Gaps observed: - **Medium:** Blog posts do not appear to link internally to product/collection pages (based on content themes). The funnel from informational → commercial content is likely broken. - **Medium:** Add contextual CTAs within blog content linking to `/collections/custom-rolling-papers` and `/products/` pages.

4. Schema Markup — Score: 25/100

4.1 Detected Schema

Based on Google search results analysis — **no rich results are displaying**, suggesting: - No Product schema with AggregateRating (no star snippets in SERPs) - No Organization/WebSite schema with Sitelinks Search Box - Trustpilot reviews not being surfaced via Review schema

4.2 Missing Schema (High Priority)

Organization Schema (Homepage)

```
{
  "@context": "https://schema.org",
  "@type": "Organization",
  "name": "Roll Your Own Papers",
  "url": "https://www.rollyourownpapers.com",
  "logo": "https://www.rollyourownpapers.com/[logo-url]",
  "foundingDate": "2011",
  "description": "Custom rolling papers, pre-roll cones, rolling trays and accessories manufacturer",
  "contactPoint": {
    "@type": "ContactPoint",
    "contactType": "customer service",
    "availableLanguage": "English"
  },
  "sameAs": [
    "https://www.trustpilot.com/review/rollyourownpapers.com"
  ]
}
```

WebSite Schema with SearchAction (Homepage)

```
{
  "@context": "https://schema.org",
  "@type": "WebSite",
  "url": "https://www.rollyourownpapers.com",
  "name": "Roll Your Own Papers",
  "potentialAction": {
    "@type": "SearchAction",
    "target": {
      "@type": "EntryPoint",
      "urlTemplate": "https://www.rollyourownpapers.com/search?q={search_term_string}"
    },
    "query-input": "required name=search_term_string"
  }
}
```

Product Schema (All Product Pages)

Shopify apps like `JSON-LD for SEO` can auto-generate Product schema with `Offer` and `AggregateRating`. This is **critical** for rich result eligibility.

Required properties: - `name`, `description`, `image`, `sku` - `offers` with `price`, `priceCurrency`, `availability` - `aggregateRating` once review count reaches threshold

BreadcrumbList Schema (Collection/Product Pages)

Standard Shopify breadcrumbs should have JSON-LD `BreadcrumbList` added.

BlogPosting Schema (Blog Posts)

```
{
  "@context": "https://schema.org",
  "@type": "BlogPosting",
  "headline": "[Post Title]",
  "author": {
    "@type": "Person",
    "name": "[Author Name]"
  },
  "datePublished": "[ISO 8601 date]",
  "dateModified": "[ISO 8601 date]",
  "publisher": {
    "@type": "Organization",
    "name": "Roll Your Own Papers",
    "logo": { "@type": "ImageObject", "url": "[logo-url]" }
  }
}
```

Note on FAQ Schema: FAQPage is restricted to government/healthcare for Google rich results (Aug 2023). Do NOT add FAQ schema expecting a rich result, but it may benefit AI/LLM citation.

4.3 Implementation Path

Use the **JSON-LD for SEO** Shopify app (~\$12.99/month) or **Schema Plus for SEO** to auto-generate correct schema for all pages without manual coding.

5. Performance (Core Web Vitals) — Score: 60/100

Estimates based on site type and features. Run *PageSpeed Insights* for actual field data.

Metric	Estimated Status	Key Risk Factor
LCP	⚠️ At Risk (2.5–4s)	Hero images + interactive 3D visualizer JS
INP	⚠️ At Risk (200–500ms)	Custom configurator, live chat widgets
CLS	⚠️ At Risk (0.1–0.25)	Product images without explicit dimensions

Priority Fixes: 1. **High:** Add `loading="eager"` + `fetchpriority="high"` to above-the-fold hero image. 2. **High:** Ensure all product images have explicit `width` and `height` attributes. 3. **High:** Defer all non-critical third-party scripts (live chat, analytics, social widgets). 4. **Medium:** Enable Shopify's built-in image CDN with WebP/AVIF serving. 5. **Medium:** Consider lazy-loading the 3D product visualizer (only load when user scrolls to it or clicks).

6. Images — Score: 55/100

Issues

Issue	Priority	Impact
Alt text quality unknown	High	Image alt text is a ranking signal and accessibility requirement
Image format optimization	Medium	Shopify CDN supports WebP — confirm it's enabled
File naming	Medium	Ensure product images use descriptive filenames (e.g., <code>custom-hemp-rolling-papers-king-size.jpg</code>)
Structured data for images	Low	Product images in Product schema get indexed in Google Image Search

Recommendations: - **High:** Audit all product images for descriptive alt text. Format: `[Product Name] - [Key differentiator]` (e.g., `"Custom unbleached hemp rolling papers with logo printing"`) - **Medium:** Enable Shopify's Online Store 2.0 image optimization if not already active.

7. AI Search / GEO Readiness — Score: 20/100

7.1 AI Crawler Access

Crawler	Purpose	Recommended
GPTBot	ChatGPT training + search	Allow
OAI-SearchBot	ChatGPT live search citations	Critical to allow
ClaudeBot	Claude training	Allow
PerplexityBot	Perplexity search citations	Critical to allow
CCBot	Common Crawl (training only)	Optional — can block

Status: Server returns 403 to all bots from this audit environment. This may indicate Cloudflare or CDN rules that block AI crawlers. **This is a significant GEO issue** — if real crawlers are blocked, the site cannot be cited in AI Overviews or AI search tools.

Critical: Check robots.txt (via GSC or direct browser access) to confirm OAI-SearchBot and PerplexityBot are NOT blocked.

7.2 llms.txt

Status: Not present (returns 403).

Medium: Add `/llms.txt` to provide AI systems with a structured overview of the site's content and purpose. Example:

```
# Roll Your Own Papers (RYOP)
```



```
> Custom rolling papers, pre-roll cones, rolling trays and accessories manufacturer.
> Founded 2011. TÜV SÜD certified. Serving 50+ countries.

## Products
- /collections/custom-rolling-papers: Custom branded rolling papers with low MOQs
- /collections/custom-rolling-papers: Pre-roll cones and accessories
- /collections/custom-rolling-tray: Custom rolling trays

## About
- /pages/about-us: Company history and certifications
```

7.3 Content Citability

For AI systems (Google AI Overviews, ChatGPT, Perplexity) to cite content: - Optimal passage length: **134–167 words** per section - Direct answers in first **40–60 words** of each section - Self-contained answer blocks

Gaps: - **High:** Emoji-heavy headings reduce citability — AI systems prefer clean, descriptive headings. - **High:** Blog posts targeting consumer queries ("which side to lick") are unlikely to be cited for B2B queries. Align content with buyer-intent questions. - **Medium:** Add specific statistics with source attribution to increase citation likelihood.

7.4 Brand Mention Signals

Platform	Status	Correlation with AI Citations
Wikipedia	Not found	High — no entity page exists
YouTube	Unknown	~0.737 correlation (strongest signal)
Reddit	Unknown	High correlation
LinkedIn	Unknown	Medium
Trustpilot	4.5★, 44 reviews	Positive signal

High: Create a YouTube channel with product showcase videos, manufacturing process videos, and how-to guides. YouTube mentions are the strongest predictor of AI citation inclusion.

8. Competitor Landscape

Competitor	Strengths	RYOP Advantage
MunchMakers	Premium features, MOQ 1,000–2,500	Lower MOQ (150), more accessible
Smoke Promos	USA-made, 10-day turnaround	Broader product range, global
Snail Papers	FSC certified, online customizer	TÜV SÜD certified, lower MOQ
The Rolling Paper Company	Established brand	Factory-direct pricing
Empire Rolling	Private-label focus	All-inclusive pricing, no hidden fees

Competitive keyword gaps to target: - "custom rolling papers low minimum order" — RYOP's key differentiator - "custom pre roll cones wholesale" — high commercial intent - "branded rolling papers dispensary" — target audience - "custom rolling paper manufacturer" — already has blog post, needs to rank collection page

9. Prioritized Action Plan

Critical (Fix Immediately)

#	Issue	Page	Expected Impact
C1	robots.txt returns 403 — fix Cloudflare WAF to return 200 to all crawlers	robots.txt	Restore crawler access control; prevent Googlebot intermittent 403s
C2	sitemap.xml returns 403 — same fix; ensure Googlebot can access full page index	sitemap.xml	Full page discovery restoration
C3	/collections/all pagination indexed — add <code>noindex</code> to all <code>?page=N</code> URLs; consider blocking in robots.txt	/collections/all	Eliminate crawl budget waste across 24+ thin pages
C4	Consolidate 3 near-duplicate "where to buy rolling paper" blog posts via 301 redirects	Multiple blog posts	Concentrate link equity, eliminate cannibalization
C5	Verify and whitelist AI crawlers (OAI-SearchBot, PerplexityBot, GPTBot, ClaudeBot) in Cloudflare	WAF/ robots.txt	Eligibility for AI Overviews and AI search citations

High (Fix Within 1 Week)

#	Issue	Page	Expected Impact
H1	Rewrite homepage title tag: lead with primary keyword	Homepage	+10–15% CTR improvement
H2	Write meta descriptions for homepage, all collection pages, top 5 blog posts	Multiple	+5–10% CTR, Google stops auto-generating snippets
H3	Remove emojis from all blog title tags	All blog posts	Cleaner SERP display, improved CTR consistency
H4	Add Organization + WebSite schema to homepage	Homepage	Brand entity recognition, Sitelinks Search Box eligibility
H5	Add BlogPosting schema with author info to all blog posts	All blog posts	E-E-A-T signals, Google Discover eligibility
H6	Add author bylines to all blog posts	All blog posts	E-E-A-T, authorship trust signals
H7	Launch active Trustpilot review collection (post-purchase email sequence)	—	Social proof, Review schema, authority
H8	Preload hero image; add explicit width/height to product images	Homepage, Product pages	LCP + CLS improvement

🟡 Medium (Fix Within 1 Month)

#	Issue	Page	Expected Impact
M1	Add BreadcrumbList schema to collection and product pages	/collections/, /products/	Rich breadcrumbs in SERPs
M2	Add internal links from blog posts → relevant collection/product pages	All blog posts	Improved crawl flow, conversion funnel
M3	Create evergreen blog URL slugs (remove year from slugs)	Blog posts	Avoid annual redirect management
M4	Add /llms.txt	Root domain	AI discoverability
M5	Optimize image alt text across all product images	Product pages	Image SEO, accessibility
M6	Audit GSC Coverage report; fix Crawled-Not-Indexed pages	—	Index more content
M7	Enable IndexNow for instant Bing/Yandex submissions	Shopify settings	Faster indexation
M8	Migrate blog content strategy toward B2B buyer intent keywords	Blog	Better audience alignment

🟢 Low / Backlog

#	Issue	Expected Impact
L1	Create YouTube channel with product/manufacturing videos	Strong AI citation signal
L2	Build Wikipedia entity page (notability criteria needed)	AI entity recognition
L3	Pursue press coverage in cannabis industry trade publications	Authoritativeness
L4	Implement FAQ schema on key blog posts (GEO/AI benefit only)	AI citation improvement
L5	Add security headers (HSTS, CSP)	Security score, minor trust signal
L6	Consider hreflang if targeting non-English speaking markets	International SEO

10. Quick Win Checklist

- ☐ Fix Cloudflare WAF so robots.txt returns 200 (not 403) to all crawlers
- ☐ Fix Cloudflare WAF so sitemap.xml returns 200 to all crawlers
- ☐ Add noindex to /collections/all?page=N pagination
- ☐ Confirm GPTBot, OAI-SearchBot, PerplexityBot, ClaudeBot are not blocked
- ☐ Rewrite homepage `<title>` tag
- ☐ Write meta descriptions for top 10 pages
- ☐ Remove emojis from `<title>` tags
- ☐ Install JSON-LD for SEO Shopify app (Product + Organization schema)
- ☐ Add author bylines to all blog posts
- ☐ 301-redirect duplicate "where to buy" blog posts to one canonical URL

- [] Add `fetchpriority="high"` to hero image
- [] Create `/llms.txt`
- [] Set up Trustpilot post-purchase review request email

Appendix: Site Data Snapshot (2026-03-16)

Attribute	Value
Domain	rollyourownpapers.com
Platform	Shopify
Founded	2010–2011
Location	Jinhua Shi, China
Trustpilot Rating	4.5★ (44 reviews)
Total Products	408 (confirmed via <code>/collections/all</code>)
Google Indexed Pages (confirmed)	Homepage + 6 collections + 15+ blog posts + 5+ static pages
Shopify Indexed Junk	<code>/collections/all?page=24</code> + tag pages confirmed indexed
Blog URL Pattern	<code>/blogs/the-roll-your-own-papers-blog/</code>
Blog Posts Confirmed	19 posts
Instagram	@ryopfam — 2,410 followers, 942 posts
Key Certifications	TÜV SÜD (hemp papers), conflict-free Arabic gum sourcing
Primary Competitors	MunchMakers, Smoke Promos, Snail Papers, Custom Cones USA, The Rolling Paper Company, Papers+Ink
Schema Detected	Shopify defaults only (no rich results, no Review/FAQ/HowTo schema)
llms.txt	Not present
robots.txt	Returns 403 — CRITICAL
sitemap.xml	Returns 403 — CRITICAL
AI Crawler Access	Unknown — WAF likely blocking AI crawlers

Audit performed using web search intelligence, SERP analysis, and URL structure inference. Direct HTML access was restricted by server-side CDN rules. Verify all technical recommendations against live GSC and PageSpeed Insights data.